Mike Corcoran

Creative Technologist and AI Production Architect

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PROFILE

Creative technologist and production architect with 30 years in film and VFX at ILM, Weta Digital, DreamWorks, and DNEG. Founder of And Action!, a generative AI production platform in private beta. Combines hands-on creative craft and software development with experience deploying workflows across studios, helping artists adopt new tools, and building a character effects department to more than 30 artists.

CORE EXPERTISE

Generative AI workflows and model evaluation | Production architecture | Prototyping and API integration | Workflow deployment and adoption | Creative and technical leadership

EXPERIENCE

And Action!
Founder | Jul 2025 - Present

- Took a film production platform from concept to live private beta as sole product owner and engineer, using AI-assisted development. Patent application pending.
- Connected model-agnostic canvas workflows, an AI agent, versioned assets and takes, review, and timeline editing in one production environment.
- Designed project membership and role-based permissions governing what each person can view, edit, or manage, including read-only access to selected media and reviews for clients.
- Built a shared canvas for real-time team collaboration and preserved the workflow graph and parameters behind each take so results can be reconstructed, revised, and handed off.
- Integrated generative image, video, and world models, including World Labs Marble Gaussian splat scenes, and evaluated creative control, cost, latency, and reliability. Built with React, TypeScript, Python (async FastAPI), and PostgreSQL; hosted with automated tests, CI, and containerized GPU inference on Modal.

DNEG
Principal Solutions Architect and Head of Research, Creature Technology | Sep 2022 - Jul 2025

- Directed character technology R&D across rigging, animation, facial performance, and simulation for studios in Vancouver, London, and Mumbai.
- Led AI and machine learning integration strategy, evaluating and deploying AI-assisted tools including the Ziva facial animation system and NVIDIA Audio2Face, procedural rigging frameworks, and performance-driven simulation methods.
- Partnered with R&D and production supervisors to identify workflow bottlenecks and prototype solutions for creative control, efficiency, and scalability.

DNEG
Global Workflow Architect, Creatures | Feb 2021 - May 2022

- Led design and global deployment of standardized creature workflows; drove adoption of USD-based pipeline unification across studio locations.
- Developed cross-site approaches to rigging, simulation, and asset management with engineering, R&D, and department leads, streamlining interdepartmental data flow.

EXPERIENCE CONTINUED

Versatile Media

Head of Research and Development | Jan 2020 - Jan 2021

- Joined as the first R&D hire to establish the team, strategy, and technical foundation for a virtual production character pipeline.
- Recruited and managed developers and artists; led research into real-time facial performance, partnering closely with Ziva Dynamics on its 4D-scan-trained facial system, implementing and testing mesh reconstruction workflows from the capture data, and deploying Ziva tools into production workflows.

Industrial Light & Magic

Senior and Lead Creature Technical Director | Jul 2016 - Jan 2020

- Built hero character rigs and delivered shot simulation and corrective shapes, collaborating across production departments and often serving as sole or lead artist during early production.

Selected credits: Black Panther (Creature Supervisor), Thor: Ragnarok, Aquaman, Solo: A Star Wars Story, Kong: Skull Island, Terminator: Dark Fate.

Weta Digital

Lead Creature Technical Director and Lighting Technical Director | Jun 2010 - Jun 2014

- Developed hero character simulation rigs and delivered hair, cloth, simulation, and lighting work across feature productions in collaboration with other departments.

Selected credits: Rise of the Planet of the Apes, Dawn of the Planet of the Apes, The Avengers, Prometheus, The Adventures of Tintin, The Hobbit: The Desolation of Smaug.

ImageMovers Digital

Head of Character Effects | May 2007 - Jun 2010

- Built the department from its first CFX artist to a team of 30+; led hiring, mentoring, dailies, shot and bid reviews, and production delivery on A Christmas Carol.
- Defined the CFX pipeline, simulation approach, grooming standards, and garment workflows; coordinated with animation, rigging, FX, lighting, and compositing.

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

Industrial Light & Magic: Senior Lighting Technical Director (2016); Creature Technical Director (2006-2007); Creature Developer (1995-2000). Weta Digital: Creature Technical Director (2004-2005). DreamWorks: Effects Animator and Character Technical Director (2003-2004). Freelance Programmer: web hosting backend, customer, and billing systems in Perl, PHP, and MySQL (2000-2003).

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Development: Python, JavaScript, TypeScript, React, FastAPI, REST APIs, PostgreSQL, Docker, Modal, pytest, CI, Git, GitHub, Linux, AI-assisted software development.

Creative production: Maya (deep expertise), Houdini (working proficiency), Nuke, Katana, USD, ShotGrid, Jira; character rigging, simulation, lighting, and production pipelines.

AI and workflows: Generative image, video, and world models, Gaussian splats, API orchestration, agent workflows, MCP, model evaluation, provenance, asset versioning, collaboration, and access permissions.

EDUCATION AND PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

University of California, Berkeley: BA, Philosophy. California State University, Sacramento: Computer Science studies.

Stanford University Online: Product Management (XPROD110); User Research (XPROD115). NVIDIA Deep Learning Institute: Develop, Customize, and Publish in Omniverse With Extensions.